

canvases in cheap, cracked frames. He had collected the paintings, all right

from scrap heaps and junk shops.

I don't suppose anything illustrates the cupidity and economic ignorance of some people better than the floods of letters by which all reputedly wealthy persons are constantly plagued. I receive up to 3000 letters every month from people who are totally unknown to me. Some

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are written by women—of all ages and from all walks of life, I gather—who say they've read or heard that I'm extremely rich and currently unmarried.

"You're just the man I've always wanted for a husband .

. ." "It's plain to see that you need a wife, and I know I would fill the bill to perfection . . . " "I'll gladly divorce my husband and marry you, if you'll just send me the money to pay the lawyer's fees . . . " These are typical lines taken from some of the marriage-proposal letters sent to me. The ladies often enclose snapshots or *salon* portraits which display greater or lesser quantities of their charms. On occasion, they'll send along entire photo albums. Some of these amorous hopefuls, I might add, hint coyly—or state bluntly—that they're willing to waive the fusty formalities of marriage and overwhelm me with love and companionship provided appropriate financial arrangements are made beforehand.

But the majority of my unwanted mail—about 70

percent, according to a tally made by my secretary—is made up of letters written by people who ask me to send them money. I do not doubt for a moment that some small percentage of these are from individuals who are actually in need. Unfortunately, it is utterly impossible to separate these from the thousands sent by professional panhandlers and chronic beggars. The letters come from practically every country in the world. It would cost